

TN Election 2026

Fresher Developer Guide

Plain HTML · CSS · JavaScript | Gradious Educational Initiative

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01 Project Overview

You are building the **TN Election 2026 Portal** — a data-driven website that displays Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly election information. The site has **4 pages**, and each fresher is responsible for **one or more modules** within those pages.

Page	File	What it shows
Home	pages/index.html	CM Candidates, Alliance table, Stats, Popular Candidates, Big Fights preview, M
Candidates	pages/candidates.html	Full candidate grid with filter tabs
Big Fights	pages/bigfights.html	Head-to-head constituency matchups
2021 Results	pages/results.html	Parliament chart, Alliance summary, Results table

Tech Stack

- HTML — page structure only, no data hardcoded inside
- CSS — styling, always written mobile-first
- JavaScript — reads data files and builds HTML dynamically
- JSON/JS data files — all content stored here, never in HTML or JS logic

02 Folder Structure

Every file has **one job**. Never mix data, logic and styles in the same file.

```
tn-election-portal/
```

```
■
```

```
■■■ pages/ ← One HTML file per page
```

```
■ ■■■ index.html ← Home page
```

```
■ ■■■ candidates.html ← Candidates page
```

```
■ ■■■ bigfights.html ← Big Fights page
```

```
■ ■■■ results.html ← 2021 Results page
```

```
■
```

```
■■■ css/ ← One CSS file per page
```

```
■ ■■■ global.css ← Variables, reset (read-only for freshers)
```

```
■ ■■■ navbar.css ← Navbar styles
```

```
■ ■■■ home.css ← Home page styles
```

```
■ ■■■ candidates.css ← Candidates page styles
```

```
■ ■■■ bigfights.css ← Big Fights page styles
```

```
■ ■■■ results.css ← Results page styles
```

```
■ ■■■ footer.css ← Footer styles
```

```
■
```

```
■■■ js/
```

```
■ ■■■ components/ ← Shared across all pages
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ navbar.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ footer.js
```

```
■ ■■■ home/ ← Each module = one file
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ cm-candidates.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ alliance-table.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ stats-bar.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ popular-candidates.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ big-fights-preview.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■■ manifestos.js
```

```
■ ■ ■■ richest-highmargin.js

■ ■■ candidates/

■ ■ ■■ filter-tabs.js

■ ■ ■■ candidate-cards.js

■ ■■ bigfights/

■ ■ ■■ bigfight-cards.js

■ ■■ results/

■ ■■ parliament-chart.js

■ ■■ alliance-summary.js

■ ■■ results-table.js

■

■■■ data/ ← ALL data lives here as JS const variables

■ ■■ navbar.js

■ ■■ cm-candidates.js

■ ■■ alliances.js

■ ■■ candidates.js

■ ■■ bigfights.js

■ ■■ results2021.js

■ ■■ constituencies.js

■

■■■ assets/

■■■ images/

■ ■■ navbar/ ← tn-election-logo.svg, gradious-logo.svg

■ ■■ candidates/ ← stalin.svg, eps.svg, seeman.svg, vijay.svg

■ ■■ parties/ ← party logos

■ ■■ manifestos/ ← manifesto banner images

■■■ icons/ ← dmk.svg, admk.svg, ntk.svg, tvk.svg
```

03 Module Assignment

Each fresher owns specific files. **Only edit your assigned files.** Never touch another fresher's file.

#	Module	Data File	JS File	CSS File
1	Navbar (Shared)	data/navbar.js	js/components/navbar.js	css/navbar.css
2	CM Candidates	data/cm-candidates.js	js/home/cm-candidates.js	css/home.css
3	Alliance Table	data/alliances.js	js/home/alliance-table.js	css/home.css
4	Stats Bar	data/stats.js	js/home/stats-bar.js	css/home.css
5	Popular Candidates	data/candidates.js	js/home/popular-candidates.js	css/home.css
6	Big Fights Preview	data/bigfights.js	js/home/big-fights-preview.js	css/home.css
7	Manifestos	data/manifestos.js	js/home/manifestos.js	css/home.css
8	Richest & High Margin	data/candidates.js	js/home/richest-highmargin.js	css/home.css
9	Candidate Cards	data/candidates.js	js/candidates/candidate-cards.js	css/candidates.css
10	Filter Tabs	data/candidates.js	js/candidates/filter-tabs.js	css/candidates.css
11	Big Fight Cards	data/bigfights.js	js/bigfights/bigfight-cards.js	css/bigfights.css
12	Parliament Chart	data/results2021.js	js/results/parliament-chart.js	css/results.css
13	Alliance Summary	data/results2021.js	js/results/alliance-summary.js	css/results.css
14	Results Table	data/results2021.js	js/results/results-table.js	css/results.css
15	Footer (Shared)	data/navbar.js	js/components/footer.js	css/footer.css

04 Data Files — How to Write Them

All data is stored in the **data/** folder as plain JavaScript **const variables**. We do NOT use `fetch()` or `async` calls — just a simple variable that the browser loads via a script tag.

■ Correct format

```
// data/cm-candidates.js

const cmCandidatesData = [

  {
    name: "M K Stalin",
    party: "DMK",
    photo: "../assets/images/candidates/stalin.svg",
    partyIcon: "../assets/icons/dmk.svg",
    borderColor: "#E05A46"
  },
  {
    name: "E.P.S",
    party: "ADMK",
    photo: "../assets/images/candidates/eps.svg",
    partyIcon: "../assets/icons/admk.svg",
    borderColor: "#16A34A"
  }
];
```

■ Never do this

```
// WRONG — never hardcode data inside HTML

<div class="card">M K Stalin - DMK</div>

// WRONG — never hardcode data inside JS logic

document.getElementById("x").innerHTML = "<b>M K Stalin</b>";
```

Figma Fallback Pattern

If real data (cid array) is empty, use **figmaSeats** as the display fallback. This keeps the UI looking correct even before real data arrives.

```
// data/alliances.js

{
  pn: "AMMK",
  fullName: "AMMK (TTV Dhinakaran)",
  cid: [], // no real data yet
  figmaSeats: "11" // ← show this from Figma instead
}

// In your JS file – logic to pick the right value:
function getSeatDisplay(party) {
  if (party.cid && party.cid.length > 0) {
    return String(party.cid.length); // real data
  }
  return party.figmaSeats || "-"; // figma fallback
}
```

05 JS Files — How to Write Them

Each JS module file does exactly **3 things**: reads data, builds HTML, injects it. Nothing more. Keep it simple.

```
// js/home/cm-candidates.js

// STEP 1 – Build HTML from data
function buildCMCandidates() {

  var container = document.getElementById("cm-candidates-container");

  if (!container) return; // safety check

  // Loop over data and build HTML string
  var html = cmCandidatesData.map(function(candidate) {
    return (
      '<div class="cm-card" style="border-color:' + candidate.borderColor + '>' +
      '' +
      '<div class="cm-card__name">' + candidate.name + '</div>' +
      '<div class="cm-card__party">' + candidate.party + '</div>' +
      '</div>'
    );
  }).join("");

  // STEP 2 – Inject into the page
  container.innerHTML = html;
}

// STEP 3 – Run when page is ready
document.addEventListener("DOMContentLoaded", function() {
  buildCMCandidates();
});
```

3 Rules for JS Files

- Read from data file → never hardcode values inside JS
- One function = one job → build(), render(), toggle() are separate
- Always wrap in DOMContentLoaded → so HTML is ready before JS runs

06 CSS Rules — Mobile First Always

Write styles for **mobile first**, then add tablet and laptop overrides. This is the most important CSS rule in this project.

■ Mobile First (correct way)

```
/* MOBILE — write this first (no media query needed) */

.cm-candidates__grid {
  display: grid;

  grid-template-columns: repeat(2, 1fr); /* 2 cols on mobile */

  gap: var(--gap-md);
}

/* TABLET — 577px to 992px */
@media (min-width: 577px) {
  .cm-candidates__grid {
    grid-template-columns: repeat(3, 1fr); /* 3 cols on tablet */
  }
}

/* LAPTOP — 993px and above */
@media (min-width: 993px) {
  .cm-candidates__grid {
    grid-template-columns: repeat(4, 1fr); /* 4 cols on laptop */
  }
}
```

CSS Variables — always use these, never hardcode

```
/* These are defined in css/global.css — use them everywhere */

/* ■ Correct */

color: var(--color-dark);

padding: var(--gap-md);

font-size: var(--font-md);
```

```
/* ■ Wrong */  
  
color: #1A1A2E;  
  
padding: 16px;  
  
font-size: 14px;
```

Screen	Width	Breakpoint
Mobile	up to 576px	Default (no media query)
Tablet	577px – 992px	@media (min-width: 577px)
Laptop	993px and above	@media (min-width: 993px)

5 Golden CSS Rules

- Never use fixed widths — use %, max-width, or grid
- Images always use: width: 100%; height: auto;
- Tables always wrap in a div with: overflow-x: auto;
- Buttons and links must be minimum 44px tall (touch target)
- Test in Chrome DevTools at 375px (mobile), 768px (tablet), 1280px (laptop)

07 HTML Pages — Script Load Order

The order of script tags in HTML **matters**. A JS file can only use a variable if the data file that defines it is loaded first.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html lang="en">

<head>

<!-- 1. Global CSS always first -->

<link rel="stylesheet" href="../css/global.css" />

<!-- 2. Component CSS -->

<link rel="stylesheet" href="../css/navbar.css" />

<!-- 3. Page CSS -->

<link rel="stylesheet" href="../css/home.css" />

</head>

<body data-page="index">

<!-- Navbar renders here – never remove this div -->

<div id="navbar-container"></div>

<main>

<!-- Your section HTML goes here -->

<div id="cm-candidates-container"></div>

</main>

<!-- SCRIPTS – always at the bottom, order matters! -->

<!-- Step 1: Data files first -->

<script src="../data/navbar.js"></script>

<script src="../data/cm-candidates.js"></script>

<script src="../data/alliances.js"></script>

<!-- Step 2: Shared component scripts -->

<script src="../js/components/navbar.js"></script>

<!-- Step 3: Page module scripts -->
```

```
<script src="../../js/home/cm-candidates.js"></script>

<script src="../../js/home/alliance-table.js"></script>

</body>

</html>
```

data-page attribute — very important!

- index.html →
- candidates.html →
- bigfights.html →
- results.html →
- This tells navbar.js which nav link to highlight as active

08 Responsive Layout — What Changes Per Screen

Module	Mobile ($\leq 576\text{px}$)	Tablet (577–992px)	Laptop ($\geq 993\text{px}$)
Navbar	Logo + Hamburger	Logo + Hamburger + Brand	Logo + Links + Brand
CM Candidates	2 cards / row	2 cards / row	4 cards / row
Alliance Table	Stacked columns	Stacked columns	3 columns side by side
Stats Bar	2 × 2 grid	2 × 2 grid	4 items in a row
Popular Candidates	2 cards / row	3 cards / row	5 cards / row
Big Fights	1 card / row	2 cards / row	3 cards / row
Richest & Margin	Stacked + scroll	Stacked	Side by side
Footer	Stacked	2 columns	2 columns

09 Naming Conventions

Files & Folders — lowercase with hyphens

- cm-candidates.js
- alliance-table.js
- mk-stalin.svg
- dmk-logo.png
- CMCandidates.js
- Alliance Table.js
- MK Stalin.svg

CSS Classes — BEM naming pattern

```
/* Block */
.cm-card { }

/* Block__Element */
.cm-card__photo { }
.cm-card__name { }
.cm-card__party { }

/* Block--Modifier */
.cm-card--active { }

/* Alliance table example */
.alliance-table { }
.alliance-table__row { }
.alliance-table__seats--empty { }
```

JS Variables & Functions — camelCase

```
// Variables
var cmCandidatesData = [ ... ];
var isExpanded = false;
var PREVIEW_COUNT = 6; // constants in UPPER_SNAKE_CASE
```

```
// Functions

function buildCMCandidates() { }

function renderAllianceTable() { }

function toggleAllianceView() { }
```

10 How to Ask Claude for Help

When you need help from Claude, follow these steps so Claude understands your project instantly and gives you the **exact correct code** for this project.

Step 1

Upload this guide file

Upload this PDF first. Claude will read it and understand the project structure, conventions and rules.

Step 2

Share your current file

Paste the content of your current file (data file + JS file) so Claude can see what you have written.

Step 3

Tell Claude your module name

Say exactly which module you are working on. Example: "I am working on the Stats Bar module."

Step 4

Describe your problem clearly

Be specific. Example: "My cards are not showing on mobile. Here is my CSS:" then paste your CSS.

Example — How to ask Claude

```
Hi Claude,  
  
I have uploaded the project guide PDF.  
  
I am working on Module 4 – Stats Bar.  
  
My assigned files are:  
  
- data/stats.js  
- js/home/stats-bar.js  
- css/home.css (only the stats bar section)  
  
Problem: The stats bar is showing all 4 items stacked on laptop.  
It should show all 4 items in one row on laptop.  
  
Here is my current CSS:  
  
.stats-bar { display: flex; flex-direction: column; }  
  
Please fix it.
```

Quick Checklist before asking Claude

- Have I uploaded this guide PDF?
- Have I shared my current file content (not just describing it)?

- Have I clearly said which module/file I am working on?
- Have I described what I expected vs what actually happened?